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Light-emitting element including first semiconductor layer having exposed portion with first region and second regions

Abstract

A light-emitting element includes: a substrate; a semiconductor layered body including: a first semiconductor layer, an active layer, and a second semiconductor layer, wherein a portion of the first semiconductor layer is exposed from the active layer and the second semiconductor layer; a first electrode disposed on the exposed portion of the first semiconductor layer and electrically connected to the first semiconductor layer; a second electrode disposed on the second semiconductor layer; a first insulating layer covering the first electrode and the second electrode and having a first opening above the first electrode and a second opening above the second electrode; a first pad electrode disposed on the first insulating layer and electrically connected to the first electrode through the first opening; and a second pad electrode disposed on the first insulating layer and electrically connected to the second electrode through the second opening.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

(1) This application claims priority to Japanese Patent Application No. 2021-088186, filed on May 26, 2021, and Japanese Patent Application No. 2021-202182, filed on Dec. 14, 2021. The entire contents of these applications are hereby incorporated by reference.

BACKGROUND

(2) The present disclosure relates to a light-emitting element.

(3) Japanese Patent Publication No. 2017-28032 discloses a light-emitting element including a layered body including an n-type layer, an active layer, and a p-type layer, an n-electrode formed on the n-type layer, and a p-electrode formed on the p-type layer.

SUMMARY

(4) An object of certain embodiments is to provide a light-emitting element that is configured such that a current flows in a broader region in an active layer, and that exhibits good heat dissipation performance.

(5) A light-emitting element according to an embodiment includes a substrate, a semiconductor layered body including a first semiconductor layer of a first conduction type disposed on the substrate, an active layer disposed on the first semiconductor layer, and a second semiconductor layer of a second conduction type disposed on the active layer, a portion of the first semiconductor layer being exposed from the active layer and the second semiconductor layer, a first electrode disposed on the portion of the first semiconductor layer and electrically connected to the first semiconductor layer, a second electrode disposed on the second semiconductor layer and electrically connected to the second semiconductor layer, a first insulating layer covering the first electrode and the second electrode and having a first opening above the first electrode and a second opening above the second electrode, a first pad electrode disposed on the first insulating layer and electrically connected to the first electrode through the first opening, and a second pad electrode disposed on the first insulating layer and electrically connected to the second electrode through the second opening. In a top view, the portion of the first semiconductor layer includes a first region lying between the first pad electrode and the second pad electrode and extending in a first direction parallel to an upper surface of the substrate and a plurality of second regions extending from the first region in a second direction intersecting the first direction, the second direction being a direction from the first region to the first pad electrode. The first electrode is disposed on the first region and the plurality of second regions. The first pad electrode covers the active layer located between the plurality of second regions in a top view.

(6) According to certain embodiments, a light-emitting element that is configured such that a current flows in a wider region in an active layer and that exhibits good heat dissipation performance can be provided.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a schematic top view of a light-emitting element according to a first embodiment.

(2) FIG. 2 is a schematic cross-sectional view taken along the line II-II of FIG. 1.

(3) FIG. 3 is a schematic cross-sectional view taken along the line of FIG. 1.

(4) FIG. 4 is a schematic top view of a substrate and a semiconductor layered body of the light-emitting element according to the first embodiment.

(5) FIG. 5 is a schematic top view of the substrate, the semiconductor layered body, and a first electrode of the light-emitting element according to the first embodiment.

(6) FIG. 6 is a schematic top view of the substrate, the semiconductor layered body, the first electrode, and an insulating layer of the light-emitting element according to the first embodiment.

(7) FIG. 7 is a schematic top view of the substrate, the semiconductor layered body, the first electrode, the insulating layer, a second electrode, and a third electrode of the light-emitting element according to the first embodiment.

(8) FIG. 8 is a schematic top view of the substrate, the semiconductor layered body, the first electrode, the insulating layer, the second electrode, the third electrode, and another insulating layer of the light-emitting element according to the first embodiment.

- (9) FIG. 9 is a schematic top view of the light-emitting element according to the first embodiment.
- (10) FIG. 10 is a schematic top view of a light-emitting element according to a second embodiment.
- (11) FIG. 11 is a schematic cross-sectional view taken along the line XI-XI of FIG. 10.
- (12) FIG. 12 is a schematic top view of the substrate, the semiconductor layered body, a first electrode, and an insulating layer of the light-emitting element according to the second embodiment.
- (13) FIG. 13 is a schematic top view of a light-emitting element according to a third embodiment.
- (14) FIG. 14 is a schematic cross-sectional view taken along the line XIV-XIV of FIG. 13.
- (15) FIG. 15 is a schematic top view of the substrate, the semiconductor layered body, and a first electrode of the light-emitting element according to the third embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(16) Certain embodiments of the present disclosure will be described below with reference to the accompanying drawings. The drawings are schematic or conceptual, and the relationship between a thickness and a width of each component, the ratio between sizes of components, etc., in the drawings is not necessarily the same as those of an actual product. Also, the dimensions and ratios of the same component in different drawings may be different from each other. In the present specification and the drawings, an element that is the same as that in a drawing that has been previously described is indicated with the same reference numeral, and its repeated detailed description is omitted as appropriate.

(17) For ease of understanding, the arrangement and structure of each portion will be described below on the basis of an XYZ orthogonal coordinate system. The X-axis, the Y-axis, and the Z-axis are orthogonal to one another. The direction in which the X-axis extends is referred to as an “X direction,” the direction in which the Y-axis extends is referred to as a “Y direction,” and the direction in which the Z-axis extends is referred to as a “Z direction.” The Z direction and the reverse direction are respectively regarded as the upward and downward directions for ease of understanding, but these directions are unrelated to the direction of gravity. Viewing a member of interest from above or seeing through the member of interest as appropriate is referred to as “top view.” The direction of the arrow of the X direction is referred to as a “+X direction,” and the reverse direction is referred to as a “−X direction.” The direction of the arrow of the Y direction is referred to as a “+Y direction,” and the reverse direction is referred to as a “−Y direction.”

First Embodiment

(18) A first embodiment will be described.

(19) FIG. 1 is a schematic top view of a light-emitting element according to the present embodiment. FIG. 2 is a schematic cross-sectional view taken along the line II-II of FIG. 1. FIG. 3 is a schematic cross-sectional view taken along the line III-III of FIG. 1.

(20) A light-emitting element **100** according to the present embodiment can be flip-chip mounted. As shown in FIG. 2 and FIG. 3, the light-emitting element **100** includes a substrate **110**, a semiconductor layered body **120**, a first electrode **130**, an insulating layer **140** (corresponding to a second insulating layer), a second electrode **152**, an insulating layer **160** (corresponding to a first insulating layer), a first pad electrode **171**, and a second pad electrode **172**. The light-emitting element **100** may further include a third electrode **153**. Each part of the light-emitting element **100** will be described below in detail.

(21) The substrate **110** is a member that supports the semiconductor layered body **120**. For example, the substrate **110** is a member used for epitaxially growing the semiconductor layered body **120**. The substrate **110** is a light-transmissive member made of sapphire or the like.

(22) Other examples of the material of the substrate **110** include spinel (MgAl.sub.2O.sub.4), silicon carbide (SiC), silicon (Si), zinc sulfide (ZnS), zinc oxide (ZnO), gallium arsenide (GaAs), diamond, lithium niobate, and neodymium gallate. The upper surface of the substrate may have a plurality of projections.

(23) The substrate **110** has the shape of a flat plate. The upper surface of the substrate **110** is substantially parallel to the X direction and the Y direction. In the case in which the upper surface of the substrate has a plurality of projections, the portion of the upper surface of the substrate not provided with the projections is substantially parallel to the X direction and the Y direction. As shown in FIG. **1**, the substrate **110** has a rectangular shape in a top view in the present embodiment. Two of the four sides constituting the outline of the substrate **110** are substantially parallel to the X direction, and the other two sides are substantially parallel to the Y direction in a top view. The shape of the substrate is not limited to the above shape but can be, for example, a polygonal shape such as a triangular shape and a hexagonal shape. The term “substantially parallel” as used herein indicates that misalignments of about 5° are acceptable.

(24) The semiconductor layered body **120** is disposed on the upper surface of the substrate **110** as shown in FIG. **2** and FIG. **3**. A semiconductor such as In.sub.XAl.sub.YGa.sub.1-X-YN ($0 \leq X$, $0 \leq Y$, and $X+Y < 1$) is suitably used for the semiconductor layered body **120**. The semiconductor layered body **120** includes a first semiconductor layer **121** of a first conduction type disposed on the substrate **110**, an active layer **122** disposed on the first semiconductor layer **121**, and a second semiconductor layer **123** of a second conduction type disposed on the active layer **122**.

(25) FIG. **4** is a schematic top view of the substrate and the semiconductor layered body of the light-emitting element according to the present embodiment.

(26) As for the first semiconductor layer **121**, a region exposed from the active layer **122** and the second semiconductor layer **123** and a region in which the second semiconductor layer **123** is disposed in a top view are indicated by different types of oblique hatching for ease of understanding in FIG. **4**.

(27) For example, the first semiconductor layer **121** is an n-type semiconductor layer. The first semiconductor layer **121** covers substantially the entire region of the upper surface of the substrate **110** except for an outline region **111a**. In the present embodiment, the first semiconductor layer **121** has a substantially rectangular shape in a top view.

(28) The active layer **122** is located on the first semiconductor layer **121**. The active layer **122** covers substantially the entire portion of the upper surface of the first semiconductor layer **121** except for a portion **121s**. The portion **121s** of the upper surface of the first semiconductor layer **121** is a surface in the upper surface of the first semiconductor layer **121** exposed from the active layer **122** and the second semiconductor layer **123**.

(29) For example, the second semiconductor layer **123** is a p-type semiconductor layer. The second semiconductor layer **123** is located on the active layer **122**. The second semiconductor layer **123** covers substantially the entire upper surface of the active layer **122**. In other words, the second semiconductor layer **123** and the active layer **122** have substantially the same shape in a top view, and the portion **121s** of the upper surface of the first semiconductor layer **121** is exposed from both the active layer **122** and the second semiconductor layer **123**.

(30) In the present embodiment, the portion **121s** of the first semiconductor layer **121** includes a first region **121s1** and a plurality of second regions **121s2** in a top view. The portion **121s** of the first semiconductor layer **121** may include a plurality of third regions **121s3** and two fourth regions **121s4** and **121s5** in a top view.

(31) The first region **121s1** extends in a first direction D1 parallel to the upper surface of the substrate **110**. The first direction D1 is the same as the Y direction in the present embodiment. The first direction may differ from the Y direction. For example, the first direction may intersect the X direction and the Y direction. The first region **121s1** includes a center C of the first semiconductor layer **121** in a top view in the present embodiment. In the case in which the first semiconductor layer has a quadrangular shape in a top view as in the present embodiment, the center C is located on the intersection point of the diagonals of the outline of the first semiconductor layer **121** in a top view. In the case in which the first semiconductor layer has a trapezoidal shape, the center of the first semiconductor layer can be the center of gravity of the trapezoidal shape. In the case in which

the first semiconductor layer has a regular polygonal shape or a triangular shape in a top view, the center of the first semiconductor layer is located at the center of the inscribed circle of the regular polygonal shape or the triangular shape.

(32) A length L1 of the first region **121s1** in the first direction D1 is equal to a length L2 of the semiconductor layered body **120** in the first direction D1 in the present embodiment. In a second embodiment described below, the length L1 differs from the length L2, and the length L1 is 60% or more of the length L2. Further, in a third embodiment described below, the length L1 is equal to the length L2. Accordingly, in the first embodiment, the second embodiment, and the third embodiment, the length L1 is 60% or more and 100% or less of the length L2.

(33) Each second region **121s2** extends from the first region **121s1** in a second direction D2 intersecting the first direction D1. In the present embodiment, the second direction D2 is the -X direction. For example, each of a plurality of second regions **121s2** preferably extends from the first region **121s1** orthogonally to the first direction D1. For example, a plurality of second regions **121s2** are preferably arranged at substantially uniform intervals in the first direction D1. With the second regions **121s2** disposed as described above, variations in the current density distribution can be reduced. The term “substantially uniform intervals” as used herein indicates that variations in intervals of 1 μm or less are acceptable.

(34) The statement “the second region extends in the second direction” as used in the present specification indicates that the second region at least partially extends in the second direction. Accordingly, the whole of each second region does not necessarily extend in the second direction as long as a portion extends in the second direction. Specifically, for example, in the case in which the first semiconductor layer has a rectangular shape in a top view, the first semiconductor layer may include a second region that extends toward a corner of the first semiconductor layer as a whole. In this case, the second region extends in a direction intersecting the first direction and the second direction as a whole but partially extends in the second direction. The first semiconductor layer includes such a second region, which allows for easily spreading a current to the corners of the first semiconductor layer. The direction in which one second region extends as a whole may be the same as or different from the direction in which another second region extends as a whole. For example, the first semiconductor layer may include one second region extending in the second direction as a whole and another second region extending in a direction intersecting the first direction and the second direction as a whole.

(35) The width in the first direction of an end of the second region on the first region side may be different from the width in the first direction of an end of the second region on the second direction side. For example, the width of the second region in the first direction may decrease toward the second direction. With such a structure, the area of the active layer can be broadened.

(36) Similarly, each third region **121s3** extends from the first region **121s1** in a third direction D3 intersecting the first direction D1. The third direction D3 is the +X direction in the present embodiment. For example, each of a plurality of third regions **121s3** preferably extends orthogonally to the first direction D1. For example, a plurality of third regions **121s3** are preferably arranged at substantially uniform intervals in the first direction D1. With the third regions **121s3** disposed as described above, variations in the current density distribution can be reduced.

(37) The statement “the third region extends in the third direction” as used in the present specification indicates that the third region at least partially extends in the third direction. Accordingly, the whole of each third region does not necessarily extend in the third direction as long as a portion extends in the third direction. Specifically, for example, in the case in which the first semiconductor layer has a rectangular shape in a top view, the first semiconductor layer may include a third region that extends toward a corner of the first semiconductor layer as a whole. In this case, the third region extends in a direction intersecting the first direction and the third direction as a whole but partially extends in the third direction. The first semiconductor layer includes such a third region, which allows for easily spreading a current to the corners of the first

semiconductor layer. The direction in which one third region extends as a whole may be the same as or different from the direction in which another third region extends as a whole. For example, the first semiconductor layer may include one third region extending in the third direction as a whole and another third region extending in a direction intersecting the first direction and the third direction as a whole.

(38) The width in the first direction of an end of the third region on the first region side may be different from the width in the first direction of an end of the third region on the third direction side. For example, the width of the third region in the first direction may decrease toward the third direction. With such a structure, the area of the active layer can be broadened.

(39) The number of the second regions **121s2** is equal to the number of the third regions **121s3** in the present embodiment. With the number of the second regions **121s2** equal to the number of the third regions **121s3**, variations in the current density distribution can be reduced. The number of the second regions may be different from the number of the third regions. The number of the second regions and the number of the third regions are not limited to the numbers above as long as each number is two or more. The arrangement of the second regions **121s2** and the third regions **121s3** is preferably symmetric in a top view. With such an arrangement of the second regions **121s2** and the third regions **121s3**, variations in the current density distribution can be reduced.

(40) The two fourth regions **121s4** and **121s5** are each continuous with the first region **121s1** and extend along the outline region **111a** of the substrate **110**. Specifically, the one fourth region **121s4** includes a first portion extending from the end in the +Y direction of the first region **121s1** toward the -X direction, a second portion extending from the end in the -X direction of the first portion toward the -Y direction, and a third portion extending from the end in the -Y direction of the second portion toward the +X direction to be continuous with the end of the first region **121s1** in the -Y direction. The other fourth region **121s5** includes a first portion extending from the end in the +Y direction of the first region **121s1** toward the +X direction, a second portion extending from the end in the +X direction of the first portion toward the -Y direction, and a third portion extending from the end in the -Y direction of the second portion toward the -X direction to be continuous with the end of the first region **121s1** in the Y- direction.

(41) As described above, the portion **121s** of the first semiconductor layer **121** preferably includes a plurality of second regions **121s2** and a plurality of third regions **121s3**. The shape of the portion of the first semiconductor layer exposed from the active layer and the second semiconductor layer is not limited to the above shapes. For example, the portion of the first semiconductor layer may include only the first region and a plurality of second regions. Alternatively, for example, the portion of the first semiconductor layer may include only the first region and a plurality of third regions extending in the third direction.

(42) These regions **121s1**, **121s2**, **121s3**, **121s4**, and **121s5** of the upper surface of the first semiconductor layer **121** exposed from the active layer **122** and the second semiconductor layer **123** are located below the regions of the upper surface of the first semiconductor layer **121** covered with the active layer **122** and the second semiconductor layer **123** as shown in FIG. 2. For example, these regions **121s1**, **121s2**, **121s3**, **121s4**, and **121s5** are formed by forming the active layer **122** and the second semiconductor layer **123** over substantially the entire upper surface of the first semiconductor layer **121** and then removing a portion of the first semiconductor layer **121**, a portion of the active layer **122**, and a portion of the second semiconductor layer **123**.

(43) As shown in FIG. 4, in the present embodiment, the active layer **122** and the second semiconductor layer **123** each include two regions **124a** and **124b** separated from each other by the first region **121s1**. The length L1 of the first region **121s1** in the first direction D1 is equal to the length L2 of the semiconductor layered body **120** in the first direction D1 in the present embodiment as described above, so that the active layer **122** and the second semiconductor layer **123** are divided by the first region **121s1**.

(44) The one region **124a** includes a first extending region **125a** extending in the first direction D1,

a plurality of intermediate regions **125b** continuous with the first extending region **125a** and located between the second regions **121s2** adjacent to each other, and two second extending regions **125c** continuous with the first extending region **125a** and located on both sides of the second regions **121s2** in the Y direction in a top view. Similarly, the other region **124b** includes a first extending region **126a** extending in the first direction D1, a plurality of intermediate regions **126b** continuous with the first extending region **126a** and located between the third regions **121s3** adjacent to each other, and two second extending regions **126c** continuous with the first extending region **126a** and located on both sides of the third regions **121s3** in the Y direction in a top view. Accordingly, the active layer **122** located between a plurality of second regions **121s2**, that is, each intermediate region **125b** of the active layer **122**, overlaps with the intermediate region **125b** of the second semiconductor layer **123** in a top view. Similarly, the active layer **122** located between a plurality of third regions **121s3**, that is, each intermediate region **126b** of the active layer **122**, overlaps with the intermediate region **126b** of the second semiconductor layer **123** in a top view. (45) As shown in FIG. 2 and FIG. 3, the first electrode **130** is disposed on the portion **121s** of the first semiconductor layer **121**. The first electrode **130** is electrically connected to the first semiconductor layer **121**.

(46) FIG. 5 is a schematic top view of the substrate, the semiconductor layered body, and the first electrode of the light-emitting element according to the present embodiment.

(47) In FIG. 5, the region in which the first electrode **130** is disposed is indicated by oblique hatching for ease of understanding.

(48) The first electrode **130** is made of an electroconductive material such as metal. Examples of the metal used for the first electrode **130** include aluminum (Al), titanium (Ti), and ruthenium (Ru).

(49) The first electrode **130** may be made of one of these metals, may have a structure in which these metals are layered, or may be made of an alloy containing these metals.

(50) The first electrode **130** is disposed on the first region **121s1**, a plurality of second regions **121s2**, and a plurality of third regions **121s3** of the first semiconductor layer **121** and in contact with the regions **121s1**, **121s2**, and **121s3** in the present embodiment. The first electrode **130** is spaced apart from the active layer **122** and the second semiconductor layer **123**. The first electrode **130** is not disposed on the two fourth regions **121s4** and **121s5** in the present embodiment.

(51) Specifically, the first electrode **130** includes a first extending portion **131** lying on the first region **121s1** and extending in the first direction D1, a plurality of second extending portions **132** extending from the first extending portion **131** in the second direction D2 and respectively lying on the second regions **121s2**, and a plurality of third extending portions **133** extending from the first extending portion **131** in the third direction D3 and respectively lying on the third regions **121s3**. The first extending portion **131** protrudes in the +Y direction beyond the outermost second extending portion **132** and third extending portion **133** in the +Y direction in the present embodiment. The first extending portion **131** protrudes in the -Y direction beyond the outermost second extending portion **132** and third extending portion **133** in the -Y direction in the present embodiment. The first extending portion **131** is located inside the outline of the first semiconductor layer **121** in a top view.

(52) The shape of the first electrode is not limited to the above shape. For example, the first extending portion of the first electrode does not necessarily protrude in the +Y direction beyond the outermost second extending portion and third extending portion in the +Y direction. In other words, the end of the first extending portion of the first electrode in the +Y direction may be located on the extension line of the outermost second extending portion and third extending portion in the +Y direction or may be recessed in the -Y direction from the outermost second extending portion and third extending portion in the +Y direction. The first extending portion of the first electrode does not necessarily protrude in the -Y direction beyond the outermost second extending portion and third extending portion in the -Y direction. In other words, the end of the first extending portion of the first electrode in the -Y direction may be located on the extension line of the outermost second

extending portion and third extending portion in the $-Y$ direction or may be recessed in the $+Y$ direction from the outermost second extending portion and third extending portion in the $-Y$ direction.

(53) As shown in FIG. 2 and FIG. 3, the second semiconductor layer **123**, the active layer **122**, the portion **121s** of the first semiconductor layer **121**, and the first electrode **130** are covered with the insulating layer **140**.

(54) FIG. 6 is a schematic top view of the substrate, the semiconductor layered body, the first electrode, and the insulating layer of the light-emitting element according to the present embodiment.

(55) In FIG. 6, the region in which the insulating layer **140** is disposed is indicated by oblique hatching for ease of understanding.

(56) The insulating layer **140** is made of an insulating material. Examples of the insulating material used for the insulating layer **140** include silicon oxide (SiO_2) and silicon nitride (SiN).

(57) The shape of the outline of the insulating layer **140** in a top view is substantially similar to the shape of the first semiconductor layer **121**.

(58) The insulating layer **140** has an opening **141** (corresponding to a third opening) over the first region **121s1** and the first extending portion **131** of the first electrode **130**. In this structure, the first extending portion **131** is exposed from the insulating layer **140**. The position of the opening is not limited to the above position. For example, the opening may be located over the second extending portions. The opening **141** has a substantially rectangular shape in a top view in which the longitudinal direction is the first direction $D1$. The shape of the opening is not limited to the above shape.

(59) The insulating layer **140** has two openings **142a** and **142b** (corresponding to fourth openings) over the second semiconductor layer **123**. Each of the openings **142a** and **142b** overlaps with the active layer **122** located between a plurality of second regions **121s2** or a plurality of third regions **121s3** in a top view in the present embodiment. Specifically, the one opening **142a** is located over the one region **124a** of the active layer **122** and the second semiconductor layer **123**. The shape of the one opening **142a** in a top view is substantially similar to the shape of the one region **124a** and smaller than the one region **124a**. In this structure, a portion other than the outline portion of the one region **124a** of the second semiconductor layer **123** is exposed from the insulating layer **140**. Similarly, the other opening **142b** is located over the other region **124b** of the active layer **122** and the second semiconductor layer **123**. The shape of the other opening **142b** in a top view is substantially similar to the shape of the other region **124b** and smaller than the other region **124b**. In this structure, a portion other than the outline portion of the other region **124b** of the second semiconductor layer **123** is exposed from the insulating layer **140**.

(60) The insulating layer **140** continuously covers a portion of the first region **121s1** of the first semiconductor layer **121**, the entire region of each second region **121s2**, the entire region of each third region **121s3**, a portion of each of the fourth regions **121s4** and **121s5**, and the outline portion of each of the regions **124a** and **124b** of the active layer **122** and the second semiconductor layer **123**. Accordingly, as shown in FIG. 2 and FIG. 3, the insulating layer **140** is disposed between the active layer **122** and the first electrode **130** and between the second semiconductor layer **123** and the first electrode **130**, and lateral surfaces of the active layer **122** and lateral surfaces of the second semiconductor layer **123** are covered with the insulating layer **140**.

(61) FIG. 7 is a schematic top view of the substrate, the semiconductor layered body, the first electrode, the insulating layer, the second electrode, and the third electrode of the light-emitting element according to the present embodiment.

(62) In FIG. 7, the regions in which the second electrode **152** and the third electrode **153** are disposed are indicated by different types of oblique hatching for ease of understanding.

(63) The second electrode **152** is made of an electroconductive material such as metal. Examples of the metal used for the second electrode **152** include a metal having a relatively high light

reflectivity such as rhodium (Rh), nickel (Ni), gold (Au), silver (Ag), and titanium (Ti). The second electrode **152** may be made of one of these metals, may have a structure in which these metals are layered, or may be made of an alloy containing these metals. The second electrode **152** is disposed over the second semiconductor layer **123** and the insulating layer **140** and electrically connected to the second semiconductor layer **123** through the openings **142a** and **142b**. In the case in which the second electrode **152** has a layered structure of metal, for example, the light extraction efficiency can be improved by disposing a metal such as Rh and Ag, which has a relatively high light reflectivity among the above metals, on the side of the second semiconductor layer **123** and the insulating layer **140**.

(64) Specifically, the shape of the outline of the second electrode **152** in a top view is substantially similar to the shape of the outline of the insulating layer **140** in a top view, and the outline of the second electrode **152** is located inside the outline of the insulating layer **140**.

(65) The second electrode **152** has an opening **152a** over the opening **141** of the insulating layer **140**. The shape of the opening **152a** is substantially similar to the shape of the opening **141**. The opening **152a** is larger than the opening **141**. In this structure, the first extending portion **131** of the first electrode **130** and the portion of the insulating layer **140** around the opening **141** are exposed from the second electrode **152**. The shape of the opening of the second electrode is not limited to the above shape.

(66) The second electrode **152** continuously covers the insulating layer **140**, the openings **142a** and **142b** of the insulating layer **140**, and the first electrode **130** in a top view. Specifically, the second electrode **152** continuously covers the two openings **142a** and **142b** and substantially the entire region except for the outline portion and the portion around the opening **141** of the insulating layer **140**. Accordingly, the second electrode **152** covers the portion of the first extending portion **131** of the first electrode **130** except for the portion overlapping with the opening **141** in a top view, the entire region of each second extending portion **132**, and the entire region of each third extending portion **133** with the insulating layer **140** therebetween. The second electrode **152** is in contact with the regions of the second semiconductor layer **123** exposed from the insulating layer **140** in the openings **142a** and **142b** as shown in FIG. 2.

(67) The third electrode **153** is made of an electroconductive material. Similarly to the second electrode **152**, the third electrode **153** preferably contains a metal material having a relatively high light reflectivity. The third electrode **153** is disposed on the insulating layer **140** and electrically connected to the first electrode **130** through the opening **141** of the insulating layer **140**.

(68) Specifically, the third electrode **153** is disposed in the opening **152a** of the second electrode **152**. The shape of the third electrode **153** is substantially similar to the shapes of the opening **141** of the insulating layer **140** and the opening **152a** of the second electrode **152** as shown in FIG. 7. The third electrode **153** is larger than the opening **141** and smaller than the opening **152a**. The third electrode **153** is spaced apart from the second electrode **152**. The shape of the third electrode is not limited to the above shape.

(69) The third electrode **153** covers the opening **141** and the region around the opening **141** of the insulating layer **140** as shown in FIG. 2. The third electrode **153** is in contact with the region of the first extending portion **131** of the first electrode **130** exposed from the insulating layer **140** in the opening **141**.

(70) FIG. 8 is a schematic top view of the substrate, the semiconductor layered body, the first electrode, the insulating layer, the second electrode, the third electrode, and another insulating layer of the light-emitting element according to the present embodiment.

(71) In FIG. 8, the region in which the insulating layer **160** is disposed is indicated by oblique hatching for ease of understanding.

(72) Similar to the insulating layer **140**, the material of the insulating layer **160** is an insulating material. The shape of the outline of the insulating layer **160** in a top view is substantially the same as the shape of the substrate **110**.

(73) The insulating layer **160** has an opening **161** (corresponding to a first opening) over the first electrode **130**. The opening **161** is located over the first region **121s1** of the first semiconductor layer **121**. Specifically, the opening **161** is located over the end of the third electrode **153** in the $-X$ direction and extends in the Y direction. In this structure, a portion of the third electrode **153** is exposed from the insulating layer **160**. The shape and position of the opening are not limited to the above shape and position.

(74) The insulating layer **160** has a plurality of openings **162** (corresponding to second openings) over the second electrode **152**. Specifically, each opening **162** is located over the second electrode **152** and between adjacent third extending portions **133** of the first electrode **130** in a top view. That is, each opening **162** is located over the intermediate region **126b** of the second semiconductor layer **123**. In this structure, portions of the second electrode **152** are exposed from the insulating layer **160**. Each opening **162** has a rectangular shape in which the longitudinal direction is the X direction. The positions and shape of the openings are not limited to the above positions and shape. The openings are located over any of a plurality of intermediate regions of the second semiconductor layer. Accordingly, the number of the openings may be one.

(75) The insulating layer **160** continuously covers the outline region **111a** of the upper surface of the substrate **110**, the outline portion of the insulating layer **140**, the entire portion of the second electrode **152** except for the portions overlapping with the openings **162** in a top view, and the entire portion of the third electrode **153** except for the portion overlapping with the opening **161** in a top view. The insulating layer **160** covers the first electrode **130** with the third electrode **153** and the insulating layer **140** therebetween.

(76) FIG. **9** is a schematic top view of the light-emitting element according to the present embodiment.

(77) In FIG. **9**, the regions in which the first pad electrode **171** and the second pad electrode **172** are disposed are indicated by oblique hatching for ease of understanding.

(78) The first pad electrode **171** is made of an electroconductive material such as metal. Examples of the metal used for the first pad electrode **171** include nickel (Ni), titanium (Ti), platinum (Pt), copper (Cu), and gold (Au).

(79) The first pad electrode **171** may be made of one of these metals, may have a structure in which these metals are layered, or may be made of an alloy containing these metals. The first pad electrode **171** is disposed on the insulating layer **160** and electrically connected to the first electrode **130** through the opening **161** as shown in FIG. **2** and FIG. **9**.

(80) The first pad electrode **171** may have a hexagonal shape in which the longitudinal direction is the Y direction in a top view as shown in FIG. **9**. Two of six sides constituting the outline of the first pad electrode **171** are parallel to the X direction, other two sides are parallel to the Y direction, and the remaining two sides are inclined with respect to the X direction and the Y direction in a top view. With such a shape of the first pad electrode **171**, the shape is different from the shape of the second pad electrode **172** described below, so that the polarities of the first pad electrode **171** and the second pad electrode **172** can be distinguished by the shape. The shape of the first pad electrode is not limited to the above particular shape.

(81) The first pad electrode **171** continuously covers the active layer **122** located between a plurality of second regions **121s2** of the first semiconductor layer **121** in a top view and a plurality of second regions **121s2**. Specifically, the first pad electrode **171** continuously covers a portion of the first extending region **125a** of the one region **124a** of the active layer **122** and the second semiconductor layer **123**, the entire region of each intermediate region **125b**, a portion of each second extending region **125c**, the entire region of each second region **121s2** of the first semiconductor layer **121**, and the opening **161** of the insulating layer **160**. The first pad electrode **171** is in contact with the portion of the third electrode **153** exposed from the insulating layer **160** in the opening **161** as shown in FIG. **2**.

(82) Similar to the first pad electrode **171**, the second pad electrode **172** is made of an

electroconductive material such as a metal material. The second pad electrode **172** is disposed on the insulating layer **160** and electrically connected to the second electrode **152** through a plurality of openings **162**. The second pad electrode **172** is spaced apart from the first pad electrode **171**. (83) Specifically, the second pad electrode **172** has a rectangular shape in which the longitudinal direction is the Y direction in a top view in the present embodiment. The shape of the second pad electrode is not limited to the above particular shape.

(84) The second pad electrode **172** continuously covers the active layer **122** located between a plurality of third regions **121s3** of the first semiconductor layer **121** in a top view and a plurality of third regions **121s3**. Specifically, the second pad electrode **172** covers a portion of the first extending region **126a** of the other region **124b** of the active layer **122** and the second semiconductor layer **123**, the entire region of each intermediate region **126b**, and a portion of each second extending region **126c**. The second pad electrode **172** is in contact with the portion of the second electrode **152** exposed from the insulating layer **160** in each opening **162** as shown in FIG. 2.

(85) Accordingly, the first region **121s1** of the first semiconductor layer **121** is located between the first pad electrode **171** and the second pad electrode **172** in a top view. The statement “the first region **121s1** of the first semiconductor layer **121** is located between the first pad electrode **171** and the second pad electrode **172** in a top view” as used herein indicates that at least a portion of the first region **121s1** is located between the first pad electrode **171** and the second pad electrode **172**. Accordingly, the first pad electrode **171** and the first region **121s1** may partially overlap with each other in a top view as in the present embodiment, or the first pad electrode **171** and the first region **121s1** may not overlap with each other. The second direction D2 is a direction from the first region **121s1** toward the first pad electrode **171** in a top view. The third direction D3 is a direction from the first region **121s1** toward the second pad electrode **172** in a top view.

(86) For example, the first pad electrode **171** and the second pad electrode **172** are bonded to an external mounting substrate with electroconductive bonding members such as solder.

(87) Next, the operation of the light-emitting element **100** according to the present embodiment will be described.

(88) The first pad electrode **171** is electrically connected to the first semiconductor layer **121** via the third electrode **153** and the first electrode **130** as shown in FIG. 2. The second pad electrode **172** is connected to the second semiconductor layer **123** via the second electrode **152**. By applying a voltage between the first pad electrode **171** and the second pad electrode **172** using the external mounting substrate, electrons in the first semiconductor layer **121** and holes in the second semiconductor layer **123** recombine in the active layer **122**. The active layer **122** thus emits light.

(89) In the light-emitting element **100** according to the present embodiment, the first region **121s1**, a plurality of second regions **121s2**, and a plurality of third regions **121s3** of the first semiconductor layer **121** are exposed from the active layer **122** and the second semiconductor layer **123**. The first electrode **130** is disposed over the first region **121s1**, the second regions **121s2**, and the third regions **121s3**.

(90) Accordingly, electrons can also be supplied from the second regions **121s2** and the third regions **121s3** to a portion of the active layer **122** distant from the first region **121s1**. Accordingly, the region in which a current flows in the active layer **122** can be broadened in the present embodiment compared with the case in which a plurality of second regions **121s2** and a plurality of third regions **121s3** are not provided.

(91) On the other hand, in the active layer **122**, electrons are likely to be supplied from the first semiconductor layer **121** to each intermediate region **125b** located between a plurality of second regions **121s2** and each intermediate region **126b** located between a plurality of third regions **121s3** in a top view, so that the recombination is likely to occur. Each of the intermediate regions **125b** and **126b** of the active layer **122** is likely to generate heat.

(92) On the other hand, in the light-emitting element **100**, as shown in FIG. 9, the first pad

electrode **171** covers each intermediate region **125b** of the active layer **122** in a top view. The second pad electrode **172** covers each intermediate region **126b** of the active layer **122** in a top view. Accordingly, heat generated in each of the intermediate regions **125b** and **126b** of the active layer **122** is likely to be propagated to the first pad electrode **171** or the second pad electrode **172** located directly above. Accordingly, heat generated from each of the intermediate regions **125b** and **126b** of the active layer **122** can be efficiently dissipated to the outside through the first pad electrode **171** and the second pad electrode **172** located directly above. Generation of heat from the active layer **122** is likely to be great particularly in the case in which the content ratio of aluminum (Al) to gallium (Ga) is large in the semiconductor layered body **120**. Accordingly, for example, in the case in which the first semiconductor layer **121** is made of In.sub.XAl.sub.YGa.sub.1-X-YN ($0 \leq X$, $0 \leq Y$, and $X+Y < 1$) and $Y \geq 0.5$, the first pad electrode **171** preferably covers each intermediate region **125b** of the active layer **122** in a top view, and the second pad electrode **172** preferably covers each intermediate region **126b** of the active layer **122** in a top view.

(93) Next, the effects of the present embodiment will be described.

(94) In the light-emitting element **100** of the present embodiment, the portion **121s** of the first semiconductor layer **121** is exposed from the active layer **122** and the second semiconductor layer **123**. The portion **121s** of the first semiconductor layer **121** includes the first region **121s1** that is located between the first pad electrode **171** and the second pad electrode **172** and has a length in the first direction D1 parallel to the upper surface of the substrate **110** of 60% or more of the length of the semiconductor layered body **120** in the first direction D1 and a plurality of second regions **121s2** extending from the first region **121s1** in the second direction D2 intersecting the first direction D1, the second direction D2 being the direction from the first region **121s1** to the first pad electrode **171** in a top view. The first electrode **130** is disposed on the first region **121s1** and a plurality of second regions **121s2**. The region in which a current flows in the active layer **122** can thus be broadened.

(95) On the other hand, the portions of the active layer **122** located between a plurality of second regions **121s2** are likely to be supplied with electrons and generate heat. However, the first pad electrode **171** covers the active layer **122** located between a plurality of second regions **121s2** in a top view in the present embodiment. Accordingly, heat generated in the active layer **122** is easily dissipated to the outside through the first pad electrode **171** disposed directly above.

(96) With the above structure, the light-emitting element **100** that has a broadened region in which a current flows in the active layer **122** and that exhibits good heat dissipation performance can be provided.

(97) The portion **121s** of the first semiconductor layer **121** further includes a plurality of third regions **121s3** extending from the first region **121s1** in the third direction D3 intersecting the first direction D1, the third direction D3 being the direction from the first region **121s1** to the second pad electrode **172** in a top view. The first electrode **130** is further disposed on a plurality of third regions **121s3**.

(98) The region in which a current flows in the active layer **122** can thus be further broadened.

(99) On the other hand, the portions of the active layer **122** located between a plurality of third regions **121s3** are likely to be supplied with electrons and generate heat. However, the second pad electrode **172** covers the active layer **122** located between a plurality of third regions **121s3** in a top view in the present embodiment. Accordingly, heat generated in the active layer **122** is easily dissipated through the second pad electrode **172** disposed directly above. The heat dissipation performance of the light-emitting element **100** can thus be enhanced.

(100) The area of the active layer **122** covered with the first pad electrode **171** and the second pad electrode **172** in a top view is 75% or more of the area of the active layer **122** in a top view. By covering a large portion of the active layer **122** with the first pad electrode **171** and the second pad electrode **172**, the heat dissipation performance of the light-emitting element **100** can be enhanced.

(101) In the case in which the peak wavelength of light emitted from the active layer **122** is within

the ultraviolet to deep ultraviolet range, the active layer **122** is likely to generate heat. Accordingly, in the case in which the peak wavelength of light emitted from the active layer **122** is within the ultraviolet to deep ultraviolet range, the area of the active layer **122** covered with the first pad electrode **171** and the second pad electrode **172** is preferably 80% or more of the area of the active layer **122** in a top view, more preferably 90% or more of the area of the active layer **122** in a top view. The term “ultraviolet range” as used herein refers to, for example, a wavelength of 400 nm or less, and the term “deep ultraviolet range” refers to, for example, a wavelength of 300 nm or less.

(102) The active layer **122** is likely to generate heat in the case in which the content ratio of aluminum (Al) to gallium (Ga) in the semiconductor layered body **120** is large. For example, in the case in which the first semiconductor layer **121** is made of In.sub.XAl.sub.YGa.sub.1-X-YN ($0 \leq X$, $0 \leq Y$, and $X+Y < 1$) and $Y \geq 0.5$, the active layer **122** is likely to generate heat. Accordingly, in the case in which the semiconductor layered body **120** is made of In.sub.XAl.sub.YGa.sub.1-X-YN and $Y \geq 0.5$, the area of the active layer **122** covered with the first pad electrode **171** and the second pad electrode **172** is preferably 80% or more of the area of the active layer **122** in a top view, more preferably 90% or more of the area of the active layer **122** in a top view.

(103) The first pad electrode **171** continuously covers the active layer **122** located between a plurality of second regions **121s2** in a top view and a plurality of second regions **121s2**. The second pad electrode **172** continuously covers the active layer **122** located between a plurality of third regions **121s3** in a top view and a plurality of third regions **121s3**. Accordingly, heat generated in the intermediate regions **125b** of the active layer **122** located between a plurality of second regions **121s2**, the intermediate regions **126b** of the active layer **122** located between a plurality of third regions **121s3**, a plurality of second regions **121s2**, and a plurality of third regions **121s3** can be efficiently dissipated to the outside through the first pad electrode **171** or the second pad electrode **172**. The heat dissipation performance of the light-emitting element **100** can thus be enhanced.

(104) The second semiconductor layer **123** includes the intermediate regions **126b** located between a plurality of third regions **121s3** in a top view. The openings **162** are located over the intermediate regions **126b**. Accordingly, heat generated in the intermediate regions **126b** that are likely to generate heat is likely to be propagated to the second pad electrode **172** through the second electrode **152** disposed inside the openings **162**. The heat dissipation performance of the light-emitting element **100** can thus be enhanced.

(105) The opening **161** is located over the first region **121s1**. This structure inhibits electrons from being unevenly supplied from the first semiconductor layer **121** to one of the two regions **124a** and **124b** of the active layer **122**. Variations in the current density distribution in the active layer **122** can thus be reduced.

(106) The first region **121s1** includes the center C of the first semiconductor layer **121** in a top view. As described above, the first region **121s1** is located substantially at the center of the first semiconductor layer **121**, and a plurality of second regions **121s2** and a plurality of third regions **121s3** extend from the first region **121s1**. Variations in the current density distribution in the active layer **122** can thus be reduced.

(107) The light-emitting element **100** further includes the third electrode **153** disposed between the first electrode **130** and the insulating layer **160**, electrically connected to the first electrode **130**, and partially exposed from the opening **161** of the insulating layer **160**. The first pad electrode **171** is electrically connected to the third electrode **153** through the opening **161**. Accordingly, the thickness of the electrode on the first region **121s1** can be greater than in the case in which the third electrode **153** is not provided. The forward voltage can thus be reduced. In the case in which the material of the second electrode **152** is the same as the material of the third electrode **153**, the etching rates of the members to be exposed can be uniform when the openings **161** and **162** are formed in the insulating layer **160** by etching. The openings **161** and **162** can thus be easily formed by etching.

(108) The light-emitting element **100** further includes the insulating layer **140** that covers the

second semiconductor layer **123**, the active layer **122**, the portion **121s** of the first semiconductor layer **121**, and the first electrode **130** and has the opening **141** over the first electrode **130** and the openings **142a** and **142b** over the second semiconductor layer **123**. The third electrode **153** is disposed on the insulating layer **140** and electrically connected to the first electrode **130** through the opening **141**. The second electrode **152** is disposed over the insulating layer **140** and electrically connected to the second semiconductor layer **123** through the openings **142a** and **142b**.

Accordingly, the second electrode **152** and the third electrode **153** override the insulating layer **140**, and the second electrode **152** and the third electrode **153** have large areas in a top view. Light emitted from the active layer **122** is thus effectively reflected by the second electrode **152** and the third electrode **153**, so that the light extraction efficiency of the light-emitting element **100** can be improved.

(109) The openings **142a** and **142b** overlap with the active layer **122** located between a plurality of second regions **121s2** and the active layer **122** located between a plurality of third regions **121s3** in a top view.

(110) The second electrode **152** continuously covers the insulating layer **140**, the openings **142a** and **142b**, and the first electrode **130** in a top view. Accordingly, the second electrode **152** overrides the insulating layer **140** and overlaps with the first electrode **130** in a top view. The second electrode **152** formed as described above can more efficiently reflect light emitted from the active layer **122**, so that the light extraction efficiency of the light-emitting element **100** can be improved.

(111) The active layer **122** includes the two regions **124a** and **124b** separated from each other by the first region **121s1**. Such separation of the active layer **122** can reduce the area of the active layer **122** not covered with the two pad electrodes **171** and **172** in a top view and allows for dissipation of heat generated from the active layer **122** through the two pad electrodes **171** and **172**.

Second Embodiment

(112) Next, the second embodiment will be described.

(113) FIG. **10** is a schematic top view of a light-emitting element according to the present embodiment.

(114) FIG. **11** is a schematic cross-sectional view taken along the line XI-XI of FIG. **10**.

(115) FIG. **12** is a schematic top view of the substrate, the semiconductor layered body, a first electrode, and an insulating layer of the light-emitting element according to the present embodiment.

(116) A light-emitting element **200** according to the present embodiment differs from the light-emitting element **100** according to the first embodiment in that an active layer **222** and a second semiconductor layer **223** continuously surround a first region **221s1**, a plurality of second regions **121s2**, and a plurality of third regions **121s3** of the first semiconductor layer **121** in a top view.

(117) Only the differences from the first embodiment will be generally described below. Features other than the features described below are substantially the same as in the first embodiment. The same applies to other embodiments described below.

(118) In the present embodiment, the portion **121s** of the first semiconductor layer **121** exposed from the active layer **222** and the second semiconductor layer **223** differs from the portion **121s** of the first semiconductor layer **121** in the first embodiment in the shape of the first region **221s1** and the shape of a fourth region **221s4**. Specifically, both ends in the first direction D1 of the first region **221s1** extending in the first direction D1 do not reach the outline of the semiconductor layered body **120** as shown in FIG. **12**. In other words, both ends in the first direction D1 of the first region **221s1** extending in the first direction D1 are spaced apart from the outline of the semiconductor layered body **120**. The fourth region **221s4** is spaced apart from the first region **221s1**, a plurality of second regions **121s2**, and a plurality of third regions **121s3** and surrounds the regions **221s1**, **121s2**, and **121s3** along the outline region **111a** of the substrate **110**.

(119) Accordingly, the shapes of the active layer **222** and the second semiconductor layer **223** in the present embodiment also differ from the shapes of the active layer **122** and the second

semiconductor layer **123** in the first embodiment. Specifically, the active layer **222** and the second semiconductor layer **223** each have such a shape in which the two regions **124a** and **124b** in the first embodiment are connected. The active layer **222** and the second semiconductor layer **223** each have a plurality of first intermediate regions **225a**, a plurality of second intermediate regions **225b**, and an outline region **225c** in a top view. Each first intermediate region **225a** is located between adjacent second regions **121s2**. Each second intermediate region **225b** is located between adjacent third regions **121s3**. The outline region **225c** is continuous with the end of each first intermediate region **225a** in the $-X$ direction and the end of each second intermediate region **225b** in the $+X$ direction. The outline region **225c** surrounds a plurality of first intermediate regions **225a** and a plurality of second intermediate regions **225b** along the fourth region **221s4**.

(120) As described above, in the second embodiment, the length **L1** of the first region **221s1** in the first direction **D1** is 60% or more of the length **L2** of the semiconductor layered body **120** in the first direction **D1**. In the second embodiment, the length **L1** is preferably 70% or more of the length **L2**, more preferably 80% or more of the length **L2**.

(121) The above length **L1** can reduce the area of the active layer **122** not covered with the two pad electrodes **171** and **172** between the two pad electrodes **171** and **172** in a top view and allows for dissipation of heat generated from the active layer **122** through the two pad electrodes **171** and **172**.

(122) In the present embodiment, the shape of a first extending portion **231** of a first electrode **230** also differs from the first extending portion **131** in the first embodiment. Specifically, the first extending portion **231** extending in the first direction **D1** does not protrude in the $+Y$ direction beyond the outermost second extending portion **132** and third extending portion **133** in the $+Y$ direction. In other words, the end of the first extending portion **231** of the first electrode **230** in the $+Y$ direction is located on the extension line of the outermost second extending portion **132** and third extending portion **133** in the $+Y$ direction. The first extending portion **231** does not protrude in the $-Y$ direction beyond the outermost second extending portion **132** and third extending portion **133** in the $-Y$ direction. In other words, the end of the first extending portion **231** of the first electrode **230** in the $-Y$ direction is located on the extension line of the outermost second extending portion **132** and third extending portion **133** in the $-Y$ direction.

(123) In the present embodiment, an insulating layer **240** differs from the insulating layer **140** in the first embodiment in that the number of openings **242** in which the second semiconductor layer **123** is exposed is one. The opening **242** has such a shape that the openings **142a** and **142b** in the first embodiment are connected to each other.

(124) Next, the effects of the present embodiment will be described.

(125) Also in the present embodiment, similarly to the light-emitting element **100** according to the first embodiment, the portion **121s** of the first semiconductor layer **121** includes the first region **221s1** and a plurality of second regions **121s2**. The first electrode **230** is disposed on the first region **221s1** and a plurality of second regions **121s2**. The first pad electrode **171** covers the active layer **222** located between a plurality of second regions **121s2** in a top view. Accordingly, heat generated in the active layer **222** located between a plurality of second regions **121s2** can be easily dissipated through the first pad electrode **171**.

(126) In the present embodiment, the active layer **222** surrounds the first region **221s1**, a plurality of second regions **121s2**, and a plurality of third regions **121s3** in a top view. Accordingly, in the active layer **222**, a plurality of first intermediate regions **225a** located between a plurality of second regions **121s2** are continuous with a plurality of second intermediate regions **225b** located between a plurality of third regions **121s3**. Variations in the current density distribution in the active layer **222** can thus be reduced.

Third Embodiment

(127) Next, the third embodiment will be described.

(128) FIG. **13** is a schematic top view of a light-emitting element according to the present embodiment.

(129) FIG. 14 is a schematic cross-sectional view taken along the line XIV-XIV of FIG. 13.

(130) FIG. 15 is a schematic top view of the substrate, the semiconductor layered body, and a first electrode of the light-emitting element according to the present embodiment.

(131) A light-emitting element **300** according to the present embodiment differs from the light-emitting element **100** according to the first embodiment in that a first electrode **330** is disposed also on the fourth region **121s4** of the first semiconductor layer **121**.

(132) Specifically, the first electrode **330** includes two outline portions **334a** and **334b** located on the two fourth regions **121s4** and **121s5** in addition to the first extending portion **131**, a plurality of second extending portions **132**, and a plurality of third extending portions **133** as shown in FIG. 15. The one outline portion **334a** is continuous with both ends of the first extending portion **131** in the Y direction and located over the fourth region **121s4** of the first semiconductor layer **121**. The other outline portion **334b** is continuous with both ends of the first extending portion **131** in the Y direction and located over the fourth region **121s5** of the first semiconductor layer **121**. At least a portion of each of the outline portions **334a** and **334b** is covered with the insulating layer **140** as shown in FIG. 14.

(133) An insulating layer **360** in the present embodiment has an opening **362** over each second extending region **126c** to expose the second electrode **152** in addition to a plurality of openings **162** as shown in FIG. 13. Accordingly, heat generated in the active layer **122** is likely to be propagated to the second electrode **152** through the openings **362**. The heat dissipation performance of the light-emitting element **300** can thus be enhanced.

(134) A first pad electrode **371** in the present embodiment further covers a portion of the one outline portion **334a** of the first electrode **330** in a top view as shown in FIG. 13 and FIG. 14. Accordingly, heat generated in the one fourth region **121s4** of the first semiconductor layer **121** is easily dissipated to the outside through the first pad electrode **371**. The first pad electrode **371** entirely covers the one region **124a** of the active layer **122**. Accordingly, heat generated in the active layer **122** is easily dissipated to the outside through the first pad electrode **371**.

(135) Similarly, a second pad electrode **372** in the present embodiment further covers a portion of the other outline portion **334b** of the first electrode **330** in a top view as shown in FIG. 13 and FIG. 14. Accordingly, heat generated in the other fourth region **121s5** of the first semiconductor layer **121** is easily dissipated to the outside through the second pad electrode **372**. The second pad electrode **372** entirely covers the other region **124b** of the active layer **122**. Accordingly, heat generated in the active layer **122** is easily dissipated to the outside through the first pad electrode **371**.

(136) As described above, also in the light-emitting element **300** according to the present embodiment, similarly to the light-emitting element **100** according to the first embodiment, the portion **121s** of the first semiconductor layer **121** includes the first region **121s1** and a plurality of second regions **121s2**. The first electrode **130** is disposed on the first region **121s1** and a plurality of second regions **121s2**. The first pad electrode **371** covers the active layer **122** located between a plurality of second regions **121s2** in a top view. Accordingly, similarly to the light-emitting element **100** according to the first embodiment, the light-emitting element **300** that has a broadened region in which a current flows in the active layer **222** and that exhibits good heat dissipation performance can be provided.

(137) The portion **121s** of the first semiconductor layer **121** includes the fourth regions **121s4** and **121s5** continuous with the first region **121s1** and lying along the outline of the substrate **110** in a top view. The first electrode **330** is further disposed on the fourth regions **121s4** and **121s5**. The contact area between the first semiconductor layer **121** and the first electrode **330** can thus be increased. The increase in the forward voltage can thus be reduced.

Claims

1. A light-emitting element comprising: a substrate; a semiconductor layered body comprising: a first semiconductor layer of a first conduction type disposed on the substrate, an active layer disposed on the first semiconductor layer, and a second semiconductor layer of a second conduction type disposed on the active layer, wherein a portion of the first semiconductor layer is exposed from the active layer and the second semiconductor layer; a first electrode disposed on the exposed portion of the first semiconductor layer and electrically connected to the first semiconductor layer; a second electrode disposed on the second semiconductor layer and electrically connected to the second semiconductor layer; a first insulating layer covering the first electrode and the second electrode and having a first opening above the first electrode and a second opening above the second electrode; a first pad electrode disposed on the first insulating layer and electrically connected to the first electrode through the first opening; and a second pad electrode disposed on the first insulating layer and electrically connected to the second electrode through the second opening; wherein: the exposed portion of the first semiconductor layer comprises, in a top view: a first region lying between the first pad electrode and the second pad electrode and extending in a first direction parallel to an upper surface of the substrate, and a plurality of second regions extending from the first region in a second direction intersecting the first direction, the second direction being a direction from the first region toward the first pad electrode; the first electrode is disposed on the first region and the plurality of second regions; and the first pad electrode covers the active layer at locations between the plurality of second regions in a top view.
2. The light-emitting element according to claim 1, wherein: the exposed portion of the first semiconductor layer comprises a plurality of third regions extending from the first region in a third direction intersecting the first direction in a top view, the third direction being a direction from the first region toward the second pad electrode; the first electrode is further disposed on the plurality of third regions; and the second pad electrode covers the active layer at locations between the plurality of third regions in a top view.
3. The light-emitting element according to claim 2, wherein, in a top view, an area of the active layer covered with the first pad electrode and the second pad electrode is 75% or more of an area of the active layer.
4. The light-emitting element according to claim 2, wherein: the first pad electrode continuously covers the active layer at the locations between the plurality of second regions in a top view and the plurality of second regions; and the second pad electrode continuously covers the active layer at the locations between the plurality of third regions in a top view and the plurality of third regions.
5. The light-emitting element according to claim 4, the second semiconductor layer comprises an intermediate region located between the plurality of third regions in a top view; and the second opening is located above the intermediate region.
6. The light-emitting element according to claim 4, wherein the first opening is located above the first region.
7. The light-emitting element according to claim 5, wherein the first opening is located above the first region.
8. The light-emitting element according to claim 6, wherein the first region comprises a center of the first semiconductor layer in a top view.
9. The light-emitting element according to claim 8, further comprising: a third electrode disposed between the first electrode and the first insulating layer, electrically connected to the first electrode, and partially exposed from the first opening of the first insulating layer; wherein: the first pad electrode is electrically connected to the third electrode through the first opening.
10. The light-emitting element according to claim 9, further comprising: a second insulating layer covering the second semiconductor layer, the active layer, the portion of the first semiconductor layer, and the first electrode and having a third opening over the first electrode and a fourth opening over the second semiconductor layer; wherein: the third electrode is disposed on the

- second insulating layer and electrically connected to the first electrode through the third opening; and the second electrode is disposed on the second insulating layer and electrically connected to the second semiconductor layer through the fourth opening.
11. The light-emitting element according to claim 10, wherein: the fourth opening overlaps with the active layer at the locations between the plurality of second regions and the active layer at the locations between the plurality of third regions in a top view; and the second electrode continuously covers the second insulating layer, the fourth opening, and the first electrode in a top view.
12. The light-emitting element according to claim 2, wherein a length of the first region in the first direction is 60% or more of a length of the semiconductor layered body in the first direction.
13. The light-emitting element according to claim 11, wherein a length of the first region in the first direction is 60% or more of a length of the semiconductor layered body in the first direction.
14. The light-emitting element according to claim 12, wherein the active layer comprises two regions separated from each other by the first region.
15. The light-emitting element according to claim 13, wherein the active layer comprises two regions separated from each other by the first region.
16. The light-emitting element according to claim 14, wherein: the exposed portion of the first semiconductor layer further comprises a fourth region continuous with the first region and lying along an outline of the substrate in a top view; and the first electrode is further disposed on the fourth region.
17. The light-emitting element according to claim 15, wherein: the exposed portion of the first semiconductor layer further comprises a fourth region continuous with the first region and lying along an outline of the substrate in a top view; and the first electrode is further disposed on the fourth region.
18. The light-emitting element according to claim 12, wherein the active layer surrounds the first region, the plurality of second regions, and the plurality of third regions in a top view.
19. The light-emitting element according to claim 13, wherein the active layer surrounds the first region, the plurality of second regions, and the plurality of third regions in a top view.
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